Project Charter for SSC-Led Projects

Attack Surface Management Project

Version: 3.3

GCDOCS: #

Shared Services Canada
Services partagés Canada

Canada

Table of Contents

1. BUSINESS NEED OR JUSTIFICATION 3
2. PROJECT DESCRIPTION 4
3. PROJECT OBJECTIVES/DELIVERABLES 4
4. OVERALL RISKS 5
5. PROJECT SCOPE 6
6. SCHEDULE 7
7. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES 8
8. SUPPORTING ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES 11
9. PROJECT MANAGER AUTHORITY LEVELS 11
10. PROJECT GOVERNANCE AND DECISION-MAKING PROCESS 12
11. PROJECT TEAM STRUCTURE 13
12. REVISION HISTORY 15
13. APPROVALS ..... **Error! Bookmark not defined.**

PROJECT NUMBER	PROJECT NAME	PROJECT SPONSOR NAME AND DEPARTMENT	PROJECT MANAGER
	Attack Surface Management (ASM)		

ESTIMATED PROJECT COSTS (Gates 2-5)	SOURCE OF FUNDS	EXPECTED START DATE (Gate 2)	EXPECTED COMPLETION (Gate 5)
$	B-Base TB Subs/Transfers	2025/08/18	2028/01/31

1. BUSINESS NEED OR JUSTIFICATION

The Government of Canada (GC) requires strategic cybersecurity planning that addresses long-term trends while maintaining flexibility for evolving risks. To meet this need, Shared Services Canada (SSC) must enhance its ability to assess the state of its cybersecurity services, posture, and operational readiness.

However, the department currently lacks enhanced capabilities to identify and monitor assets, identify and triage vulnerabilities, and assess whether security controls are effective and compliant. This gap limits SSC's ability to assess and strengthen its cybersecurity posture, such as against state-sponsored and ideologically motivated cyber threats, which poses a significant and growing risk to Canada.

To address these challenges and enable a shift from reactive to proactive cybersecurity, SSC must implement Attack Surface Management (ASM), Vulnerability Management (VM), and Continuous Security Controls Assessment – Breach and Attack Simulation (CSCA-BAS) capabilities. These capabilities are essential to:

- Identify, prioritize, and assist with the remediation of cybersecurity vulnerabilities due to potential exposure within the GC's attack surface
- Acquire a more comprehensive and proactive approach to ASM, VM and CSCA-BAS
- Develop greater visibility and a better understanding of the GC's Attack Surface landscape
- Must employ Threat Intelligence to assess an asset's risk prioritization based on Attack Vectors
- Utilizing automation, the solution must be capable of generating an Attack Path Map
- Leverage automation to the greatest extent possible
- Continually remediate Vulnerabilities as Threat Actors evolve their exploitation methodologies
- Produce prioritized maps of exposure of GC assets
- Support IT workflows to assist with remediating issues that are detected
- Detect threats, in near real-time, that may become potential breaches or compromises; and
- ASM and CSCA-BAS to monitor external facing assets across both on-premise and cloud-based.
- VM to monitor all assets across on-premise and cloud environments.

At this time, the mandate of TBS and SSC require scalable and comprehensive ASM, VM, and CSCA-BAS capabilities to support the cybersecurity needs of the entire Government of Canada.

2. PROJECT DESCRIPTION

SSC faces the challenge of managing and reducing the GC's attack surface while strengthening its infrastructure against ever-evolving cyber threats. Additionally, the rapid adoption of new technologies and interconnected systems has resulted in an expanded attack surface that requires proactive management and defensive strategies.
Through Treasury Board of Canada Secretariat (TBS), the ASM project has secured funding to become a critical component in fortifying the GC's cybersecurity posture. The project will procure and deploy three capabilities designed to shift SSC from a reactive to a proactive approach:

1. Attack Surface Management

The ASM capability will provide visibility into all external-facing assets by:

- detecting external-facing assets across SSC's IT infrastructure;
- mapping potential attack surfaces; and
- providing prioritized, actionable intelligence to support SSC's remediation and mitigation activities.

2. Vulnerability Management

The VM capability will focus on internal infrastructure assessment by:

- identifying internal assets and vulnerabilities across SSC's IT infrastructure;
- mapping potential attack surfaces; and
- providing prioritized, actionable intelligence to support SSC's remediation and mitigation activities.

3. Continuous Security Controls Assessment – Breach and Attack Simulation

The CSCA – BAS capability will assess and validate the effectiveness of implemented security controls by:

- continuous testing of the networks through simulated threat actor attacks;
- deploying rapid retesting after simulated attacks to validate effectiveness of recent changes;
- delivering critical insights into alerts, detections and security processes; and
- providing proactive vulnerability management through drift analysis.

Each capability will be deployed using a phased, iterative approach, starting with ASM, then VM and finally CSCA – BAS. Within each phase, deployments will begin with small-scale implementations, enabling SSC to deliver value in shorter timeframes, align with organizational priorities and external risk factors and validate effectiveness before full-scale rollout.

3. PROJECT OBJECTIVES/DELIVERABLES

1.	Proactive Cybersecurity Posture

- Procure ASM, VM and CSCA-BAS capabilities.
- Establish continuous monitoring and assessment of SSC-managed IT infrastructure to counter cyber threats.

2. Strengthened Organizational Resilience
   - Implement ASM, VM and CSCA-BAS capabilities to identify, monitor and assess all external-facing and internal assets within SSC's IT infrastructure.
   - Deploy continuous testing of networks through simulated attacks to identify gaps in alerts, detections and security processes.
   - Enable rapid retesting to validate effectiveness of security improvements and changes.
3. Protected Critical Services and Data
   - Mitigate vulnerabilities at public access points that enable critical services for Canadians.
   - Bolster the GC's cybersecurity posture to defend mission-critical IT systems and infrastructure.
4. Integrated Security Intelligence
   - Map potential attack surfaces across the entire SSC-managed infrastructure.
   - Provide prioritized, actionable intelligence to support SSC's remediation and mitigation activities.
   - Deliver continuous reporting on security posture, cybersecurity trends, and capability effectiveness to support the GC's Enterprise Cyber Security Strategy.
   - Export ASM and VM capability data into the Self-Serve Vulnerability Access Portal for integrated security management.

4. OVERALL RISKS

RISK	PROBABILITY	IMPACT	MITIGATION
RSK–1 (CCCS Cloud Assessment) There is a risk that cloud assessment timeline could take longer than anticipated. If the duration of the assessment activity is greater than two months, this will delay the deployment of the ASM capability.	Medium	Medium	Mitigate. Early Engagement: Initiate early discussions to better understand potential delays and incorporate feedback early in the assessment process. Advanced Notification: Provide early notification about the project timeline and critical deadlines to seek prioritization for the cloud assessment. Parallel Task Management: Identify and progress other critical project tasks that are not dependent on the cloud service

RISK	PROBABILITY	IMPACT	MITIGATION
			assessment to maintain overall project momentum. Buffer Time in Schedule: Incorporate buffer time into the project schedule specifically to accommodate potential delays in the cloud assessment.
RSK-2 (ASM Capability - SA&A Timeline) There is a risk that the Security Assessment and Authorization (SA&A) timeline for ASM Capability could take longer than anticipated, which will delay ASM capability deployment.	Medium	Medium	Mitigate. Parallel Activity Advancement: Focus on advancing other project activities and deliverables that can be completed independently of the SA&A process to keep the overall project on track. Detailed Assessment Plan: Develop a comprehensive assessment plan with detailed timelines and milestones, and communicate this plan to all stakeholders to facilitate better coordination and prevent delays. Interim Security Measures: Implement interim security measures that can temporarily satisfy security requirements until the full SA&A process is completed, as advised by Project Governance. Incremental Deployment Strategy: Plan for an incremental deployment of ASM capabilities where possible, to allow partial functionality to go live while waiting for final SA&A approval, with oversight from Project Governance.
RSK-3 (Procurement Timelines) There is a risk that procurement may take longer than planned, which will result in increased project costs and project delays.	Low	Low	Mitigate. Increased Collaboration: Frequently communicate with procurement team and vendors to clarify timelines and expectations.

RISK	PROBABILITY	IMPACT	MITIGATION
			Funding: Engage with the Sponsor and Project Management Board (PMB) to ensure funding availability and prevent lapses, especially for extended procurement timelines. Project Reprioritization: Adjust project milestones and deliverables to account for potential procurement delays, while ensuring timely delivery of critical components. Proactive Planning: Begin procurement process early and include buffer periods in the project schedule to accommodate potential delays. Integrated Security Reviews: Schedule regular reviews with Project Gouvernance to regularly assess and mitigate security risks during prolonged procurement processes.

5. PROJECT SCOPE

The ASM project will procure, install and deploy Attack Surface Management (ASM), Vulnerability Management (VM) and Continuous Security Controls Assessment - Breach & Attack Simulation (CSCA-BAS) capabilities for SSC managed IT infrastructure.

Business Case (For SSC-led projects only)	

6. SCHEDULE

KEY MILESTONES		START (YYYY-MM-DD)	FINISH (YYYY-MM-DD)
Intake and Concept (Gate 0)		2023-11	2024-05-08
Investment (Gate 1)		2024-05-09	2024-10-09
Preliminary Planning (Gate 2)	All capabilities	2024-10-09	2025-08-18

Detailed Planning (Gate 3)	ASM	2025-08-18	2026-05-19
	VM	2025-08-18	2026-09-15
	CSCA - BAS	2025-08-18	2027-03-17
Execution (Gate 4)	ASM	2026-05-20	2026-11-17
	VM	2026-09-16	2027-04-20
	CSCA - BAS	2026-10-18	2027-09-14
Deployment and Closeout (Gate 5)	All capabilities	2028-01-28	2028-01-31

7. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

ROLE	NAME and TITLE	RESPONSIBILITIES
Business Owner		• Acts as champion for the project; • Accountable for realizing the benefits and outcomes of the project • Approves the Business Case and other project deliverables prior to departmental review and approval; • Secures the required resources and funds to deliver the project; • Stays abreast of project status; • Approves change requests (within authorized limits) or recommends to the project governance committee.
Project Sponsor		• Facilitates the key organizational support needed to create a successful project; • Accepts the results and outcome of the project, and will typically act as the business owner once the project's deliverables are placed into operation; • Puts the service (i.e. the results of the project) into operation; • Provides business requirements, on behalf of the end users; • Provides validation, verification and testing of the project deliverables, including User Acceptance Testing; • Ensures user adoption.

ROLE	NAME and TITLE	RESPONSIBILITIES
PM&D Director General		• Lead overall project direction and guidance from Gate 2 to Gate 5 of the PGoF; • Operate a Project Management Office (PMO) for projects within the Directorate; • Ensure standards and best practices are adhered to; • Ensure that project data is up to date in the project repository tool; • Ensure that project deliverables are stored and kept current; • Ensure current project financial data in the financial system; • Liaise with the WLM Program to ensure projects remain in alignment with Program objectives and outcomes; and • Liaise with the Project Management Centre of Excellence (PMCoE) for current templates, forms, best practices, and project oversight tools.
PM&D Senior Director		• Participate in overall project direction and guidance; • Review and monitor project progress and budget; • Provide input on strategy and major issue resolution; • Ensure that the appropriate resources are available; and • Encourage the adoption of best practices.
PM&D Director		• Ensures standards and best practices are adhered to; • Ensures that project data is up-to-date in the project repository tool; • Ensures that project deliverables are stored and kept current; • Ensures that project financial data is kept current in the financial system; • Liaises with the Project Management Centre of Excellence (PMCoE) for current templates, forms, best practices, and project oversight tools.
Project Manager		• Is fully responsible for the successful completion of the project;

ROLE	NAME and TITLE	RESPONSIBILITIES
		• Supports the Business Owner and the Project Sponsor in the realization of the project outcomes; • Is responsible for day-to-day management of the project, including management of the Project Team; • Ensures adherence to the SSC Directive for Project Management; • Develops and secures approval for all project documents; • Achieves the approved project scope within the planned (baseline) cost and schedule; • Monitors variances in the project scope, cost and schedule against the approved scope, cost and schedule baseline plans, and takes required corrective actions; • Implements communications plans, and ensures engagement of stakeholders; • Ensures proactive and continuous management of risks and issues, facilitating the resolution or appropriate escalation; • Ensures Project Change Requests for all changes to baseline scope, cost and schedule are completed and approved; • Approves change requests (within authorized limits); • Provides timely, consistent, and accurate project status reporting.

8. SUPPORTING ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

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9. PROJECT MANAGER AUTHORITY LEVELS

Project Team Staffing Decisions	✓ Staffing decisions will be made by the Director General. The Project Manager will report any issues as they arise to the Director General
Budget Management and Variances	✓ The Project Manager's level of authority for budget management reflects the direction from the Director General. The Project Budget will be managed by the Project Manager and any variance in the budget will be escalated to the Senior Director for review within the Project-Level Governance.
Schedule Decisions	✓ The Project Manager has authority to make changes to the project schedule. Any change to the project schedule that impacts cost and risk or impacts any project constraints will be presented to the Senior Director for review and decision. A presentation to the Project Steering Committee may be required.
Scope Decisions	✓ All scope changes will be presented by the Project Manager to the DCSP Senior Director for review. A presentation to the Project Steering Committee may be required
Project Change Request Decisions	✓ The Project Manager has authority to approve minor changes that do not impact the scope, increase risk, and affect the schedule.

	Project changes that modify the scope, increase risk and affect the schedule will be reviewed by the Senior Director. Presentation to the Project Steering Committee as recommended by the Senior Director.
Technical Decisions	✓ Authority for technical decisions defers to Subject Matter Experts and SSC advisory groups – discussions facilitated by the Project Manager.
Conflict Resolution	✓ Conflicts will be dealt with by the PM at the working level and escalated as required, through established project governance.
Escalation Path for Authority Limitations	✓ The path to follow for escalating any issues, risk, conflicts or decisions if they cannot be resolved by the Project Manager will follow the project-level governance process.

10. PROJECT GOVERNANCE AND DECISION-MAKING PROCESS

The project will seek Gating approvals through the SSC Project Management Board in accordance with the SSC Project Governance and Operating Framework.

The implementation and management of the ASM Project falls under the responsibility of the SSC Project Management and Delivery Branch (PM&D), who is managing the project on a day-to-day basis in collaboration with the Connectivity and Security Services Branch (CSSB).

Through PM&D, the project reports to the ASM Director Steering Committee and the ASM Director General Steering Committee with representatives from the IT Security Tripartite (ITST).

The ASM Project Steering Committees report to the Project Management Board (PMB). The ASM Project Steering Committees have access to other boards, as identified in Figure 10-1, depending on the item to be addressed or approvals sought. Further oversight is offered through the IT Security Tripartite Committee branch of the governance structure to provide an escalation channel and recommendations for TB Submissions.

The Project Team is supported by technical, corporate and project management teams who collectively compile the necessary project update information and report up to the Steering Committees. For Committee membership refer to the ASM Steering Committees *Terms of Reference*.

Embedded within the Project Governance Structure below, the Governance for the ASM project includes the following internal and external reporting.

Internal Reporting:

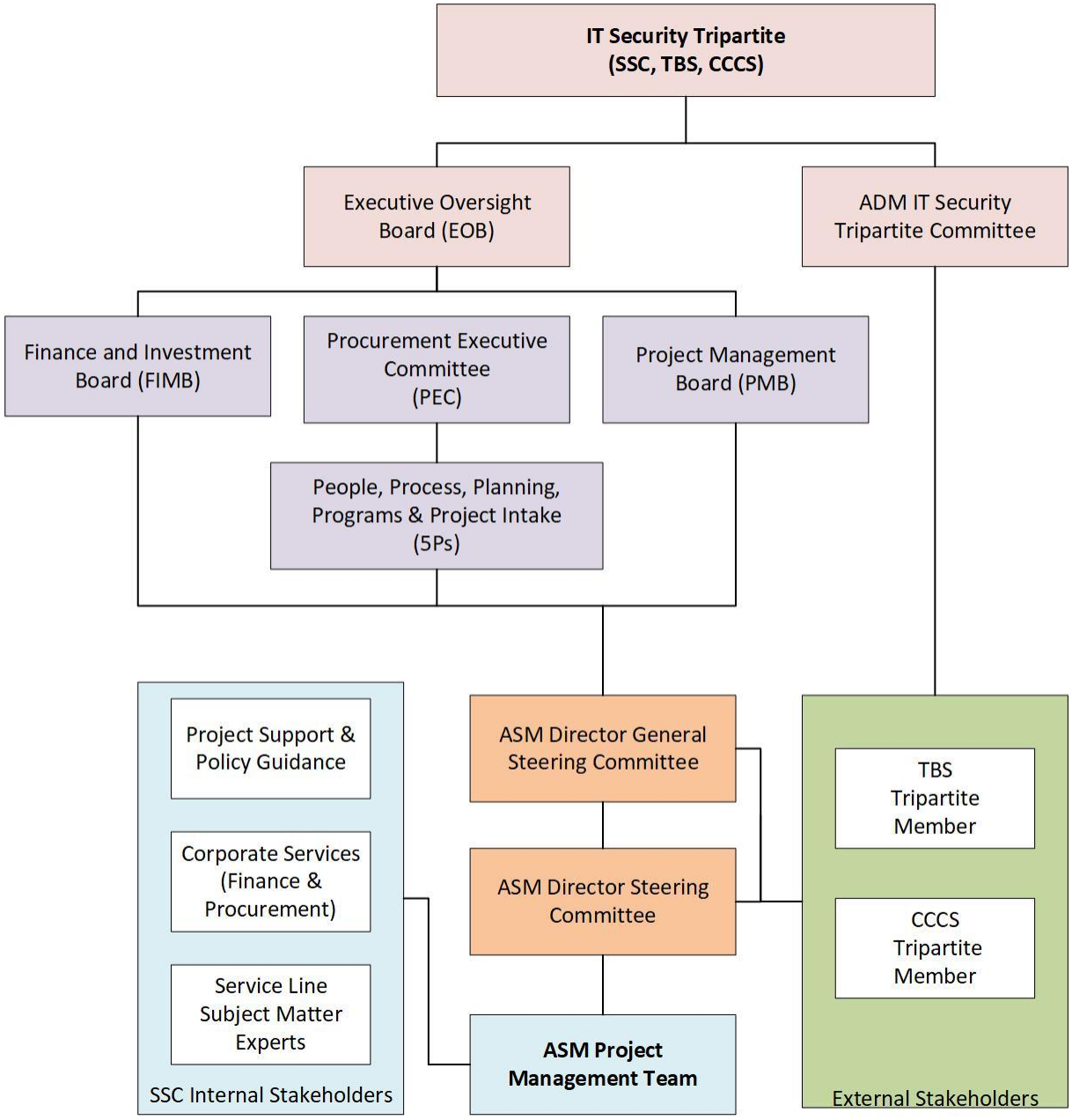
- Steering Committee – Director Level (TBS, SSC) – Monthly
- Steering Committee – Director General Level (TBS, SSC) - Monthly
- Project Management Board (PMB)- As required.
- Finance, Investment Management Board (FIMB) – As required.

External Reporting:

- IT Security Tripartite (ITST) (SSC, TBS)

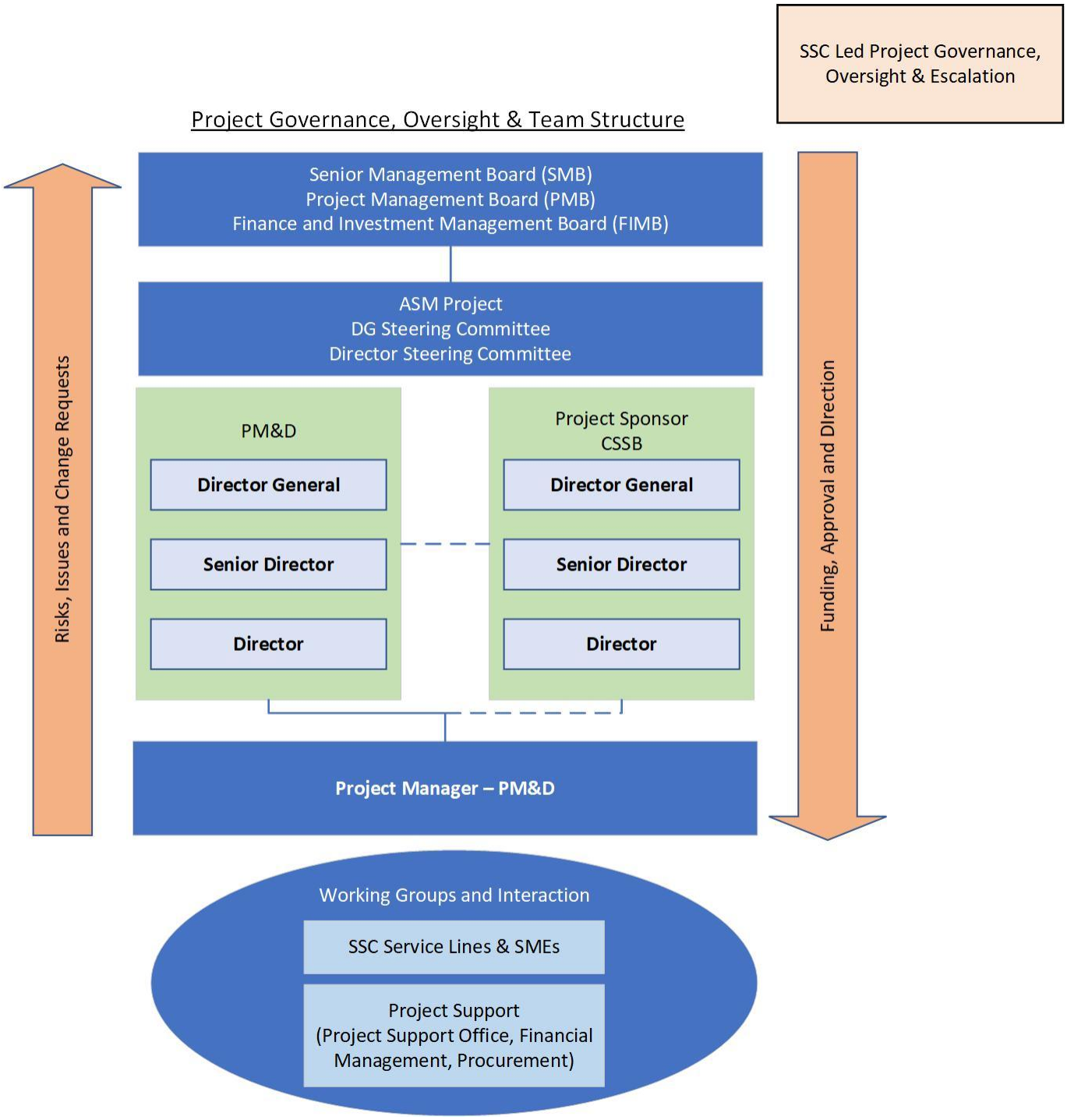
Any change to Scope, Schedule and Cost will follow the SSC Change Management process.

Figure 1: Project Governance Structure



11. PROJECT TEAM STRUCTURE

Figure 2: Project Team Structure



Note: SSC service lines report to PM&D in a matrix management structure to complete project deliverables for the CSSB project sponsor.

12. REVISION HISTORY

Version Number	Description of edits made	Date Modified	Author
2.2	Approved project charter for original Gate 2.	2025-01-16	ASM project team
3.0	Initial version for new Gate 2 date (August 18, 2025) using new template.	2025-06-09	
3.1	Updated Project Team Structure, Supporting Roles & Responsibilities	2025-06-24	
3.2	Minor updates per feedback from project sponsor, service lines and project lead.	2025-07-03	
3.3	Updated Supporting Roles to include PMD Security Practitioner.	2025-07-11	